

Chapter 8 – Updating Taxpayer Information

8.1 Introduction

After obtaining a **Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)**, taxpayers are responsible for ensuring that their registration information remains accurate and up to date. The Inland Revenue Department (IRD) requires taxpayers to update their personal, business, and contact information whenever changes occur. Keeping taxpayer information current helps ensure effective communication, accurate tax administration, and uninterrupted access to IRD e-Services.

Taxpayer information can be updated through the **IRD e-Services Portal** or by visiting the **Customer Information Update Unit** at the IRD Head Office or any Regional Office.

8.2 Why It Is Important to Update Taxpayer Information

Maintaining accurate taxpayer information helps the Inland Revenue Department to:

- Maintain correct taxpayer records.
- Deliver important notices and communications.
- Process tax registrations and returns efficiently.
- Verify taxpayer identity.
- Ensure uninterrupted access to e-Services.
- Avoid delays caused by outdated information.

Taxpayers are strongly advised to keep their **email address** and **mobile phone number** updated, as these are frequently used for communication and account-related notifications.

8.3 Methods of Updating Taxpayer Information

The IRD provides two methods for updating taxpayer information.

Method 1 – Online

Taxpayers can update their information using the IRD e-Services Portal.

General steps include:

1. Log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.

2. Navigate to **Taxpayer Registration**.
3. Select **Change Taxpayer Detail Request**.
4. Update the required information.
5. Upload supporting documents.
6. Review the application.
7. Submit the request.
8. Save the acknowledgement generated by the system.

Method 2 – In-Person

Taxpayers may also visit:

- Customer Information Update Unit
- IRD Head Office
- Any Regional Inland Revenue Office

Applicants should carry the required supporting documents for verification.

8.4 Updating Personal Information

Individual taxpayers may update various personal details, including:

- Name (where applicable)
- Permanent address
- Residential address
- Contact information
- Email address
- Mobile number
- Civil status
- Children's information
- Bank account information
- Individual business information

Changes should be supported by appropriate documentation where required.

8.5 Updating Address Information

Taxpayers may update:

- Permanent address
- Residential address
- Business address
- Tax type address (where applicable)

When updating an address, supporting documents may include:

- Utility bill
- Bank statement
- Grama Niladhari Certificate
- Lease agreement or deed (where applicable)

The new address should accurately reflect the taxpayer's current place of residence or business.

8.6 Updating Contact Information

Taxpayers should promptly update their:

- Mobile phone number
- Email address
- Other contact details

Maintaining current contact information helps ensure that important notifications, acknowledgements, and other communications from the IRD are delivered successfully.

8.7 Updating Business Information

Individual business owners may update information relating to their businesses.

Business details that can be updated include:

- Business name
- Business registration number
- Principal business activity
- Date of commencement
- Business address
- BOI registration details
- Primary business status

Where applicable, updated business registration certificates should be provided.

8.8 Updating Company Information

Registered companies may update information relating to:

- Company address
- Contact person
- Company contact details
- Directors
- Company registration information
- Bank account information

Depending on the nature of the change, supporting documents such as Registrar of Companies forms or amended registration certificates may be required.

8.9 Updating Director Information

Companies may add, remove, or update directors through the IRD e-Services Portal.

The system allows searches using:

- National Identity Card (NIC)
- Passport Number
- Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

If a director is already registered with the IRD, their information may be retrieved automatically.

Supporting documentation should be provided where necessary.

8.10 Supporting Documents Required

Depending on the information being updated, taxpayers may need to provide supporting documents.

Examples include:

Individuals

- National Identity Card (NIC)
- Passport (Foreign Nationals)
- Proof of Address
- Business Registration Certificate

Companies

- Amended Business Registration Certificate
- Registrar of Companies Forms
- Directors' Identification Documents
- Address Verification Documents

Partnerships

- Partnership Registration Certificate
- Identification of Partners
- Lease Agreement (where applicable)

Other Organizations

- Registration Certificate
- Letter of Request
- Letter of Appointment
- Trust Deed
- Joint Venture Agreement
- Gazette or Act (where applicable)

8.11 Uploading Supporting Documents

When submitting an online update request:

1. Select the appropriate document type.
2. Choose the relevant sub-document category.
3. Upload clear electronic copies.
4. Confirm successful upload.
5. Repeat the process for additional documents if required.

Poor-quality or incomplete documents may delay processing.

8.12 Declaration and Submission

Before submitting an update request, taxpayers should:

- Review all updated information.
- Ensure the details are accurate.
- Enter the required declaration information.
- Submit the request electronically.

Following successful submission, the system generates an acknowledgement, which should be retained for future reference.

8.13 Common Reasons for Update Requests

Taxpayers commonly update their information when:

- Moving to a new address.
- Changing their mobile number.
- Updating their email address.
- Starting a new business.
- Changing business activities.
- Appointing new company directors.
- Updating company registration details.
- Correcting previously submitted information.
- Updating bank account information.

8.14 Best Practices

Taxpayers should:

- Update changes as soon as possible.
- Ensure all supporting documents are current and accurate.
- Keep email addresses and mobile numbers active.
- Verify uploaded documents before submission.
- Retain acknowledgement receipts for future reference.
- Regularly review taxpayer information through the IRD e-Services Portal to ensure it

remains accurate.

8.15 Key Points

- Taxpayer information should be updated whenever personal, business, or contact details change.
- Updates can be completed online through the IRD e-Services Portal or by visiting an IRD office.
- Different supporting documents are required depending on the type of information being updated.
- Accurate taxpayer information helps prevent communication issues and delays in tax administration.
- Every successful update request generates an acknowledgement that should be retained for future reference.